# Darling What If — Traffic, Engagement & UX Report

Nov 9, 2026 · @Gia

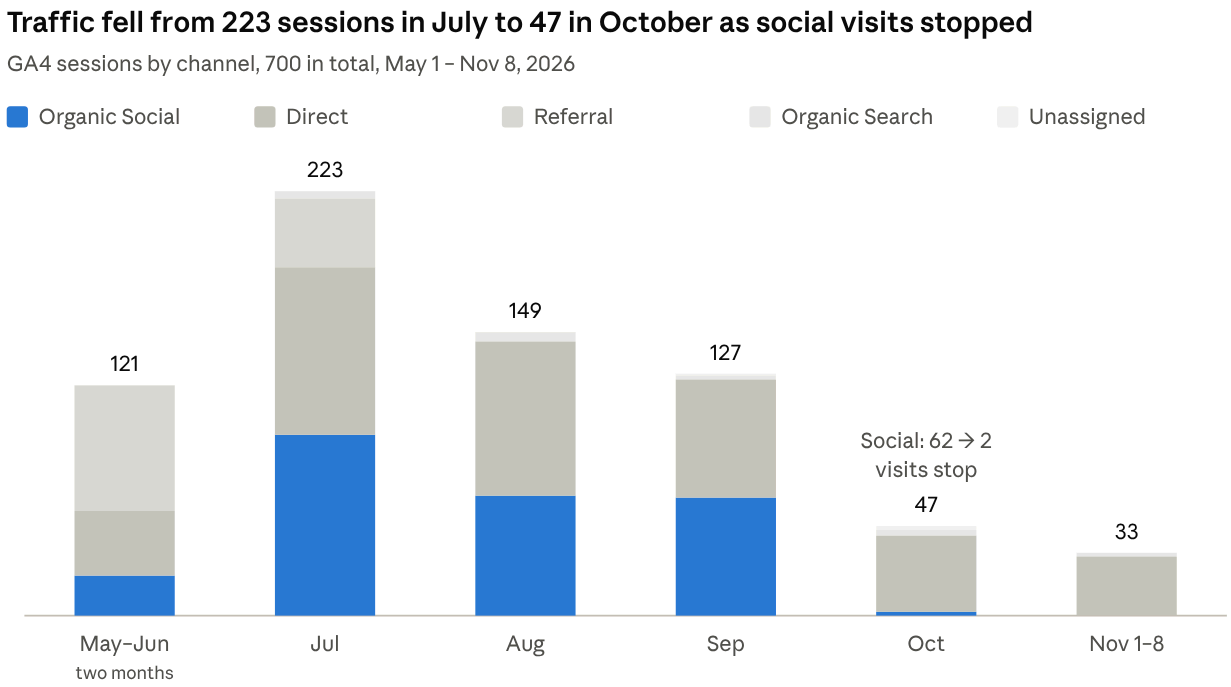
## Executive summary

The site gets almost all of its readers from Pinterest, and Pinterest traffic stopped in October. Meanwhile Google indexes only 8 of 142 pages, so search can't replace it yet. Over the last 28 days the site had 64 sessions, only 11 of them engaged (17%), down from 55 of 80 the month before.

- **Traffic (GA4, May 1 – Nov 8):** 701 sessions from 267 users. Pinterest brought 175 sessions with 82% engagement and about 2 minutes per visit, your best audience by far. Social traffic, mostly Pinterest, went from 62 sessions in September to 2 in October and 0 in November.
- **Search:** 16 sessions from organic search in six months. Only 8 of 142 pages are in Google's index, mainly because post links are added by script and the old URLs return 404 (see Indexing).
- **What's left is mostly noise:** most recent "Direct" sessions last 4–6 seconds and come from data-center cities (Ashburn, Council Bluffs), which suggests bots, not readers (inference).
- **Engagement:** readers who arrive from Pinterest, Threads or your sister site sagemyhealth.com stay 1–2 minutes. But only 11% of users ever scroll to the end of a page, and posts have no newsletter signup, so there's no way to bring readers back.
- **User experience:** pages load fast (0.2s largest paint, no layout shift). The bigger problems are layout: on post pages the hero image fills the first screen, so the headline is below the fold. On the homepage, "Latest Reads" is four screens down and links only 10 of about 120 posts.
- **Do first:** restart pinning, add a Pinterest Save button and an in-post newsletter signup, fix post links and redirects for Google, and filter out bot and internal traffic so the numbers can be trusted.

# Traffic

Pinterest built this site's audience, and when Pinterest sessions stopped in October, traffic fell 79% from its July peak. Lifetime totals (May 1 – Nov 8, 2026) are 701 sessions, 267 users and a 57.8% engagement rate, with 58 seconds of engagement per session.




Google Analytics 4, Traffic acquisition by session channel, one pull per month · May 1 – Nov 8, 2026

| Source / medium | Sessions | Engagement rate | Avg engagement time | Read |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| (direct) / (none) | 336 | 42.9% | 27s | Mixed: you, bookmarks, and bots (see below) |
| Pinterest (organic + pinterest.com referral) | 175 | 81.8% / 75% | 1m 57s / 1m 48s | Your best channel: real, engaged readers |
| sagemyhealth.com / referral | 69 | 75.4% | 2m 01s | Your own sister site; strong fit, active May–July |

| Source / medium | Sessions | Engagement rate | Avg engagement time | Read |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| facebook.com + m.facebook.com / referral | 62 | 71.4% / 0% | 4s / 0s | Visits but no reading |
| l.threads.com / referral | 29 | 69.0% | 1m 12s | Small but engaged |
| google + bing / organic | 13 | 57.1% / 16.7% | 14s / 4s | Blocked by indexing (see Indexing) |
| ig / social | 6 | 16.7% | 0s | Instagram link not converting |

**Last 28 days vs. previous 28 (Oct 12 – Nov 8 vs. Sep 14 – Oct 11):** sessions 64 vs. 80; engaged sessions 11 vs. 55; engagement rate 17.2% vs. 68.8%; engagement per session 13s vs. 1m 05s. Organic Social went from 30 to 0.

**The Direct traffic is suspect.** In October and November, Direct sessions averaged 4–6 seconds at 15–23% engagement. The cities with the most users last week were Ashburn, VA and Council Bluffs, IA, both large data-center hubs. China, Ireland and Sweden (43 users) show 2–8 seconds per visit. All of this points to bots or crawlers, not readers (inference). GA4 only filters known bots.

**Audience:** 69% of users are in the US. Chrome users average 3m 25s and 62% engagement; Safari users average 27s and 28%. GA4 isn't linked to Search Console, so organic queries don't show up in GA4 yet.

## Engagement

Readers who arrive on purpose do engage: Pinterest, Threads and sagemyhealth.com visitors stay 1–2 minutes. But the site gives them no way to stay in touch and few prompts to read on, so almost nobody comes back or converts.

| Signal (GA4, May 1 – Nov 8) | Value | What it means |
|---|---|---|
| Engagement rate, all sessions | 57.8% (17.2% in the last 28 days) | Healthy until the readers left; now dominated by bot-like Direct visits |
| Engagement time per session | 58s | Short for 2,000-word posts with a 10-minute read time |
| Users who scrolled to 90% of a page | 29 of 267 (10.9%) | About 1 in 9 users reaches the end of a page, where the related posts sit |
| Newsletter form starts | 4 events, 1 user | Effectively no signups; no signup is tracked as a key event |
| Key events (outbound "click") | 15 | The only key event set up; it doesn't measure reader value |
| Short visits on posts people land on | dog-sad 9s, quiet-self 6s, gut-axis 6s (8–10 sessions each) | Those who land on a post often leave within seconds |

**Treat these numbers with caution.** Category pages show 10–18 views per user (`/mind` 339 views from 22 users, `/living` 197 from 11). That pattern usually means a few people visiting over and over, very likely your own visits while building the site. I couldn't confirm whether an internal-traffic filter is on. Until both your own visits and bots are filtered out, GA4 overstates page views and understates engagement.

**What's working:** posts are readable (18.4px text, a 640px line length, generous line spacing). Each shows a read time and ends with a "You might also love" block. Schema (BlogPosting, FAQ, breadcrumbs) is in place on the post checked.

**What's missing:**

- **No newsletter signup inside posts.** The only form is at the bottom of the homepage, about nine screens down. Pinterest readers land on posts and never see it.
- **No Pinterest Save button** on post images, even though Pinterest is your best channel.
- **No table of contents** on 2,000-word posts, so readers can't jump to the part they came for.
- **The related-posts block sits at the very end**, which only about 11% of users reach.

## User experience

The site is fast and beautifully typeset. Its UX problems are about the order of things: what readers see first, and how far they have to scroll to find the next thing to read. I checked this on Nov 9 in Chrome at a narrow 738 × 828 window (close to a tablet view). Search Console has too little traffic for a Core Web Vitals report, and I couldn't run a PageSpeed Insights lab test from here.

| Area | Observed | Verdict | Fix |
|---|---|---|---|
| Speed (post-self-love) | Server response 110ms, largest paint 0.22s, layout shift 0.000, full load 0.42s; 226 KB of scripts (ads + analytics) | Good | Run PageSpeed Insights on mobile monthly to confirm on a slower connection |
| Post opening | The hero image fills the whole first screen; the headline, date and read time start below it | Needs work | Cap the hero at about 50–60% of screen height, or put the headline above the image |
| Homepage length | Full-screen featured story, then a marquee, then one large "This Week's Story" image; "Latest Reads" starts about 4 screens down; the page is about 9.5 screens long | Needs work | Move Latest Reads and Explore by Category up, directly under the featured story |
| Homepage depth | 10 posts linked out of about 120 | Needs work | Show 20–30 recent posts, plus a "Start here" row of 3–5 best posts |
| Navigation | Menu has Beauty, Mind, Nourish, Living, Love, About; Companion, Travel and Gut Health pages exist but aren't in it | Fix | Add them, or group them under the nearest pillar |
| Newsletter | One form, at the bottom of the homepage only | Fix | Add a short inline signup after the 2nd section of each post, and at the end |

| Area | Observed | Verdict | Fix |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pinterest | No Save button on images | Fix | Add a hover Save button, plus one vertical 2:3 pin image per post |
| Long posts | No table of contents | Improve | Add a collapsible "In this post" list linked to the H2s |
| Accessibility | Body images have alt text; the 4 social icons in the footer don't | Small fix | Add alt text ("Instagram", "Pinterest", "RedNote", "TikTok") |
| iPhone (inferred) | Safari users: 28% engagement, 27s; Chrome users: 62%, 3m 25s | Investigate | Test a post on an iPhone in Safari: check the hero, fonts, ad slot and menu |

Your Sept 15 SEO audit already covers thin category pages, author schema and orphaned posts. Those fixes still stand and overlap with the action plan below.

## Action plan

Bring the Pinterest readers back first. Make sure each visit leads to a newsletter signup or a second article. Then open up Google as a second channel. The search-specific steps are expanded in **Top 20 opportunities** below.

### This week: restore traffic and clean up the data

- [ ] **Restart Pinterest.** 3–5 fresh pins a day, rotating your posts with the most Pinterest landings so far (cruelty-free beauty, dog-sad, softness, quiet-self, gut-axis). Pinterest brought 175 sessions at 82% engagement.
- [ ] **Exclude your own visits in GA4:** Admin → Data streams → Define internal traffic (your home IP), then turn on the Internal Traffic data filter.
- [ ] **Link Search Console to GA4** (GA4 shows a one-click prompt on its home page), so search queries appear next to engagement.
- [ ] **Add 301 redirects** for the 6 URLs that return 404, and switch internal links from `.html` to clean URLs.
- [ ] **Re-share from sagemyhealth.com:** add a few contextual links to related Darling What If posts. That site sent 69 sessions at 2 minutes each.

### Next 30 days: turn visits into returning readers

- [ ] **Add an inline newsletter signup** after the 2nd section of every post and at the end. Track the signup as a GA4 key event.
- [ ] **Add a Pinterest Save button** to post images, plus one vertical 2:3 pin image per post.
- [ ] **Shorten the post hero** so the headline shows on the first screen.
- [ ] **Reorder the homepage:** featured story, Latest Reads (20–30 posts, as static HTML so Google sees them too), a Start Here row, Explore by Category, then the newsletter.
- [ ] **Add an "In this post" table of contents** to posts over 1,500 words.
- [ ] **Put post links in the static HTML** of every category page, and request indexing for the 10–15 strongest posts.
- [ ] **Test a post on an iPhone in Safari** and fix whatever is causing the 27-second visits.

### 60–90 days: build durable channels

- [ ] **Expand the six category pages** into real hubs (intro, best posts, sub-topics), as your Sept 15 audit recommends.
- [ ] **Build the two clusters with search traction:** feeling loved / attachment, and food for hair (see Content strategy).
- [ ] **Keep Threads in the rotation** (69% engagement). Fix or remove the Instagram link (6 sessions, 0s).
- [ ] **Publish less, update more,** until the indexed count passes about 60 pages. Many new posts are joining a queue Google hasn't crawled.
- [ ] **Review monthly** against the baseline in Monitoring.

## Period comparison

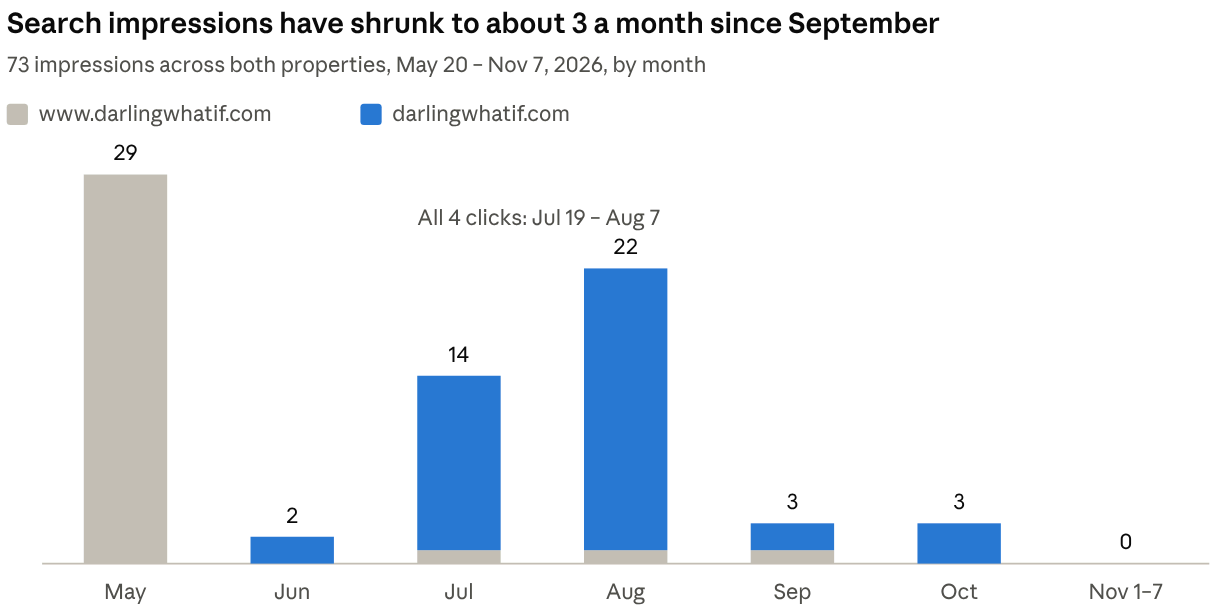
Impressions have shrunk in every period since August, and no clicks have come in since August 7. Figures are from the `https://darlingwhatif.com/` property unless noted. Search Console data runs to Nov 7, 2026 (about a 2-day delay).

| Period | Dates (2026) | Clicks | Impressions | CTR | Avg position |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Last 28 days | Oct 11 – Nov 7 | 0 | 3 | 0% | 1.3 |
| Previous 28 days | Sep 13 – Oct 10 | 0 | 1 | 0% | 1.0 |
| Last 3 months | Aug 8 – Nov 7 | 0 | 22 | 0% | 49.5 |
| Previous 3 months | May 8 – Aug 7 | 4 | 19 | 21.1% | ≈55 (from daily rows) |

| Period | Dates (2026) | Clicks | Impressions | CTR | Avg position |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lifetime | Jun 24 – Nov 7 | 4 | 41 | 9.8% | 52.1 |
| www property, lifetime | May 20 – Sep 3 | 0 | 32 | 0% | 23.9 |

There is no 12-month comparison: the first recorded impression is May 20, 2026. The small position numbers in the 28-day rows come from branded or navigational searches for the homepage and category pages, not from articles ranking well.

## Trend




Google Search Console, daily Performance rows for both URL-prefix properties, summed by month · May 20 – Nov 7, 2026

The May spike came from the www site (mostly the hair-foods post averaging position 35). July–August came from the non-www site, mostly the feeling-loved post at position 70+. Both faded as those pages left the index or stayed buried. With this little data there's no seasonal pattern to read yet.

## Indexing — the real bottleneck

Only 5.6% of known pages (8 of 142) can appear in Google. A page that isn't indexed gets zero impressions, so no title rewrite can help the other 134 until they are indexed. Page indexing report last updated Nov 5, 2026.

| Status (Search Console) | Pages | Which pages | What it means |
|---|---|---|---|
| Indexed | 8 | `/`, `/mind`, `/beauty`, `/love`, `/about`, `/gut-health`, `/post-being-loved-feeling-loved`, `/post-spf-guide` | Can appear in results |
| Discovered – currently not indexed | 107 | About 90 posts (e.g. self-love, cortisol, attachment-style, burnout, magnesium, solo-female-travel), all six `-guide` pages, `/nourish`, `/living`, `/contact`, `/privacy`, `/terms` | Google knows the URL (mostly from the sitemap) but has **never crawled it** ("Last crawled: N/A") |
| Crawled – currently not indexed | 14 | hair-foods, tea-timing, acv-honey, gut-health post, 90-30-50, period-eat-better, nyc-love, cruelty-free-beauty, dog-love, screen-skin, quiet-anxiety, small-sanctuary, morning-pages, `/travel` | Google read the page and chose not to index it yet |
| Not found (404) | 6 | `/post-companion-dogs` (+ `.html`), `/companion/dog-unconditional-love`, `/beauty/screen-skin-blue-light`, `/nourish/tea-timing`, `/nourish/acv-honey-morning-ritual-gut-health` | Old or removed URLs with no redirect |
| Page with redirect | 7 | `.html` versions (e.g. `/index.html`, `/beauty.html`) | Expected, no action needed |

The sitemap (`/sitemap.xml`, 128 URLs) was submitted Sep 3, last read Nov 9, status Success. The www property shows 0 indexed and 19 not indexed, which is expected after the site moved to the non-www domain.

**What the live site shows (checked Nov 9):**

- The posts themselves look healthy. Each has a self-referencing canonical, no `noindex`, 1,900–2,300 words, and 8–12 links to other posts.

- **Category pages carry no post links in their HTML.** `/mind` serves 193 words and 0 post links; `posts.js` adds 14 links after load. The homepage HTML links to only 2 posts. Google has to render JavaScript to find posts, and gives a new site's script-added links low priority.
- **Internal links point at `.html` addresses** (`beauty.html`, `post-gut-brain-connection.html`) that redirect to the clean URL, which adds a wasted hop for each one.
- **The old URLs return 404.** Pages Google first knew under `/nourish/…` or `/companion/…` lost their history when the URL scheme changed.
- `robots.txt` allows Googlebot. Blocking Google-Extended and GoogleOther doesn't affect search rankings.

**Fixes, in order:**

1. Put post links in the static HTML of the homepage and all six category pages (title, excerpt, link), rendered at build time, not by `posts.js`.
2. Change every internal link to the clean URL (`/beauty`, not `beauty.html`), including nav, footer and in-post links.
3. Add 301 redirects for the 6 URLs returning 404. For example: `/nourish/tea-timing` → `/post-tea-timing`, `/nourish/acv-honey-morning-ritual-gut-health` → `/post-acv-honey`, `/beauty/screen-skin-blue-light` → `/post-screen-skin`, `/companion/dog-unconditional-love` and `/post-companion-dogs` → `/post-dog-love` (confirm that's the replacement).
4. Request indexing in URL Inspection for the 10–15 strongest posts (about 10 a day is allowed). Start with the ones in the opportunity list below.
5. Fill the six category pages beyond 193 words with an intro and post summaries, so the category pages that are already indexed pass more weight to the posts they link to.

## Search queries

Google has reported only 12 queries across both properties, none with a click, and all ranking below position 40. A top 20–50 list isn't possible yet. Most impressions are anonymized: the queries below cover 16 of 41 impressions on the main property and 7 of 32 on www. All 4 clicks came from hidden queries.

| Query | Property | Impressions | Clicks | CTR | Avg position | Page it matches |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| feeling loved | darlingwhatif.com | 10 | 0 | 0% | 79.9 | /post-being-loved-feeling-loved |
| being loved and feeling loved | darlingwhatif.com | 2 | 0 | 0% | 74.5 | /post-being-loved-feeling-loved |
| how to feel loved when you are alone | darlingwhatif.com | 1 | 0 | 0% | 58.0 | /post-being-loved-feeling-loved |
| when you feel loved | darlingwhatif.com | 1 | 0 | 0% | 73.0 | /post-being-loved-feeling-loved |
| loved feeling | darlingwhatif.com | 1 | 0 | 0% | 74.0 | /post-being-loved-feeling-loved |
| what it feels like to be loved | darlingwhatif.com | 1 | 0 | 0% | 81.0 | /post-being-loved-feeling-loved |
| melanin rich foods for hair | www | 2 | 0 | 0% | 61.5 | /post-hair-foods |
| foods with melanin for hair | www | 1 | 0 | 0% | 42.0 | /post-hair-foods |
| melanin-rich foods for hair | www | 1 | 0 | 0% | 55.0 | /post-hair-foods |
| foods rich in melanin for hair | www | 1 | 0 | 0% | 78.0 | /post-hair-foods |
| foods that make your hair shiny | www | 1 | 0 | 0% | 87.0 | /post-hair-foods |
| honey and warm water for constipation | www | 1 | 0 | 0% | 54.0 | /post-acv-honey |

**What the queries show (observed):**

- Two topic clusters have pulled impressions: **feeling loved / emotional connection** and **melanin-rich foods for hair**. Both are informational, non-branded searches.
- No query sits in positions 4–20. The striking-distance and high-impression, low-CTR groups the brief asked for are empty, so CTR work comes after indexing.
- **Unexpected query:** "honey and warm water for constipation" reached the ACV & honey post, a digestive-relief angle the post may not cover directly.
- No cannibalization: each query cluster maps to one page.

# Landing pages

The homepage is the only page that has earned clicks. The best-ranking article is the hair-foods post, which reached position 35 on the www site in May and has since dropped out of the index. Lifetime figures; www rows are the old www.darlingwhatif.com URLs.

| Page | Clicks | Impressions | Avg position | Index status now | Action |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| `/` (homepage) | 4 | 10 (+3 www) | 1.1 | Indexed | Protect; add static post links |
| `/post-being-loved-feeling-loved` | 0 | 26 | 73.9 | Indexed | Expand; strengthen internal links |
| `/post-hair-foods` | 0 | 15 (www) | 34.6 | Crawled, not indexed | Request indexing; link from `/beauty`, `/nourish` |
| `/post-acv-honey` | 0 | 6 (www) | 25.3 | Crawled, not indexed | Fix old URL 404; request indexing |
| `/beauty` | 0 | 6 | 2.8 | Indexed | Add static post list + intro |
| `/about` | 0 | 6 (+2 www) | 3.8 | Indexed | None |
| `/love` | 0 | 5 | 3.8 | Indexed | Add static post list + intro |
| `/mind` | 0 | 5 | 5.2 | Indexed | Add static post list + intro |
| `/post-tea-timing` | 0 | 2 (+3 www) | 95.0 (6.3 on www) | Crawled, not indexed | Fix old URL 404; request indexing |
| `/post-companion-dogs` | 0 | 2 | 8.5 | **404 since Oct 8** | 301 to the replacement post |
| `/gut-health` | 0 | 2 | 7.0 | Indexed | None |
| `/post-spf-guide` | 0 | 2 | 7.5 | Indexed | Link from `/beauty` |
| `/travel` | 0 | 2 | 7.5 | Crawled, not indexed | Add content and post links |
| `/post-morning-pages` | 0 | 2 (www) | 24.0 | Crawled, not indexed | Request indexing |
| `/post-dog-love` | 0 | 2 (www) | 5–8 | Crawled, not indexed | Receives the companion-dogs redirect |
| `/post-cruelty-free-beauty`, `/post-nyc-love`, `/post-screen-skin`, `/post-quiet-anxiety`, `/post-gut-health` | 0 | 1 each | 3–11 | Crawled, not indexed | Request indexing in batches |

**Losing visibility:** hair-foods, ACV & honey and tea-timing had impressions on www in May, then went quiet after the move to the non-www domain. Their old `/nourish/…` URLs now 404. Companion-dogs lost its URL on Oct 8.

**Gaining:** being-loved-feeling-loved, from its first impression on Jul 12 to the August peak. Nothing has gained since September.

Positions under 10 on pages with 1–6 impressions most likely come from brand or `site:` searches, not real rankings.

## Countries and devices

US searchers see the site most (14 of 41 impressions). All 4 clicks were on mobile, from Canada, Malaysia and the Netherlands, at position 1. The sample is too small to show a real geographic or device pattern. A few branded clicks could even be you or people you've shared the site with.

| Country | Clicks | Impressions | Avg position |
|---|---|---|---|
| United States | 0 | 14 | 40.4 |
| Canada | 2 | 5 | 46.0 |
| Philippines | 0 | 4 | 77.2 |
| France, India, United Kingdom, Brazil | 0 | 2 each | 67–87 |
| Malaysia, Netherlands | 1 each | 1 each | 1.0 |
| Mexico, Hong Kong, Morocco, Australia, Indonesia, Vietnam, Poland, Thailand | 0 | 1 each | 3–77 |

| Device | Clicks | Impressions | CTR | Avg position |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mobile | 4 | 4 | 100% | 1.0 |
| Desktop | 0 | 37 | 0% | 57.7 |

The desktop impressions are the deep-ranking article results; the mobile ones are the brand searches. I didn't capture the Search appearance breakdown in this pull; at 41 impressions it is unlikely to hold anything.

## CTR and title recommendations

No page has a CTR problem yet. Every 0% CTR comes with a position of 40 or worse, where hardly anyone scrolls. These are small alignment tweaks to make once the pages are indexed and moving up, not fixes for current lost clicks.

| Page | Current title (live) | Queries it gets | Recommendation |
|---|---|---|---|
| `/post-being-loved-feeling-loved` | Being Loved vs. Feeling Loved: Why You Still Feel Alone | feeling loved (10), being loved and feeling loved, how to feel loved when you are alone | Lead with the main query: **"Feeling Loved vs. Being Loved: Why You Can Still Feel Alone"** (57 chars). The meta description already covers "how to feel loved when you're alone", so keep it. Add H2s for "What does it feel like to be loved?" and "How to feel loved when you're alone". |
| `/post-hair-foods` | 14 Melanin-Rich Foods for Hair Growth, Shine & Less Grey | melanin rich foods for hair (×4 variants), foods that make your hair shiny | Title already fits the queries; keep it. Add an H2 that answers "Which foods make your hair shiny?" directly, so the shine variant has a target. |
| `/post-acv-honey` | (not checked) | honey and warm water for constipation | If the post discusses digestion, add a short, sourced section on honey and warm water for constipation. Don't change the title for one impression. |

| Page | Current title (live) | Queries it gets | Recommendation |
|---|---|---|---|
| `/` | Darling, What If — A Life Reimagined | brand searches (hidden) | Brand clicks already land at position 1. Optionally add a descriptor for new visitors: "Darling, What If — Wellness & Lifestyle Blog for Women". |

Category pages ( `/mind` etc.) already have descriptive titles and meta descriptions. Their gap is body content, not metadata.

## Top 20 opportunities

The first six items unlock everything else, because they get the existing 2,000-word posts into Google. Each "Evidence" cell is observed Search Console or live-site data. Potential and effort are my estimates, not measurements.

| # | Opportunity | Evidence | Potential | Effort |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Render post links in static HTML on the homepage and 6 category pages | 107 pages never crawled; `/mind` HTML has 0 post links | High | Medium |
| 2 | Switch all internal links from `.html` to clean URLs | Nav, footer and homepage links point at `.html` and redirect | High | Low |
| 3 | 301 the 6 URLs that return 404 to their current posts | 6 URLs return 404, including companion-dogs (had impressions) | Medium | Low |
| 4 | Request indexing for `/post-hair-foods` | Avg position 34.6 on www, 15 impressions; now crawled, not indexed | High | Low |
| 5 | Request indexing for `/post-tea-timing` | Position 6.3 on www in May; now not indexed | Medium | Low |
| 6 | Request indexing for `/post-acv-honey` | Position 25.3 on www, 6 impressions | Medium | Low |

| # | Opportunity | Evidence | Potential | Effort |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Expand `/post-being-loved-feeling-loved` to fully answer "feeling loved" questions | 26 impressions at position 74 across 6 related queries | Medium | Medium |
| 8 | Retitle it to lead with "Feeling Loved" | "feeling loved" is 10 of its 16 visible query impressions | Low–Medium | Low |
| 9 | Add 300+ words of intro and post summaries to each category page | `/mind` has 193 words; 4 category pages are already indexed | Medium | Medium |
| 10 | Link the six `-guide` pages from category pages and request indexing | All six guides never crawled | Medium | Low |
| 11 | Love cluster: link self-love, attachment-style, anxious-attachment, emotional-safety, quiet-love, slow-love to and from being-loved-feeling-loved | The only article with query traction is in this cluster | Medium | Low |
| 12 | Nourish cluster: link gut posts to the indexed `/gut-health` hub | `/gut-health` is indexed; post-gut-health, gut-axis, gut-brain-connection, gut-glow are not | Medium | Low |
| 13 | Review near-duplicate posts and merge where they overlap (see Content strategy) | 14 crawled-not-indexed pages; overlapping titles in the URL list | Medium | Medium |
| 14 | Publish fewer new posts until the indexed share rises | 8 of 142 indexed; new URLs join the uncrawled queue | Medium | Low |
| 15 | Request indexing for `/post-morning-pages` | Position 24 on www | Low–Medium | Low |
| 16 | Pin each post on Pinterest with a direct link | Pinterest is in your footer; referral traffic helps discovery (effect on rankings unproven) | Medium | Medium |

| # | Opportunity | Evidence | Potential | Effort |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17 | Give `/travel` real content and link the Japan, Maui and solo-travel posts | Crawled, not indexed | Low | Medium |
| 18 | Add a "foods that make your hair shiny" H2 to hair-foods | 1 impression at position 87 | Low | Low |
| 19 | Add a sourced honey-and-warm-water section to ACV & honey | 1 impression at position 54 | Low | Low |
| 20 | Add a descriptor to the homepage title | Brand clicks already land at position 1 | Low | Low |

## Content strategy

The search data so far supports two clusters: **love and emotional connection**, and **food for hair**. It doesn't yet justify new articles. With about 120 posts unindexed, the content you already have is the opportunity, so build clusters around the two pages Google has shown interest in.

| Cluster | Pillar page | Supporting posts to link in both directions | Search evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| Love & emotional connection | `/post-being-loved-feeling-loved` | self-love, attachment-style, anxious-attachment, emotional-safety, emotional-unavailability, quiet-love, slow-love, touch-language, easy-to-love, choosing-someone-every-day | 6 "feeling loved" queries, 26 impressions (observed) |
| Hair & beauty nutrition | `/post-hair-foods` | hair-growth-retention, scalp-care, collagen, food-glow-guide, gut-glow | 5 "melanin foods for hair" queries (observed) |

| Cluster | Pillar page | Supporting posts to link in both directions | Search evidence |
|---|---|---|---|
| Gut health | `/gut-health` (indexed hub) | post-gut-health, gut-axis, gut-brain-connection, acv-honey, tea-timing, microbiome-skincare | 1 honey/constipation query; the hub is indexed (observed) |

**Existing articles to optimize:** being-loved-feeling-loved, hair-foods and ACV & honey (see the CTR section).

**New article topics:** none can be backed by Search Console yet. The two question-style queries ("what it feels like to be loved", "foods that make your hair shiny") fit better as H2 sections in their existing pillars than as separate posts, which would compete with the pillars.

**Possible overlap to review (inferred from URL names only, not checked against content):** gut-axis vs. gut-brain-connection; evening-sleep-routine vs. night-wind-down-routine; forever-young-at-heart vs. growing-up-keeps-you-young vs. looking-younger; anxiety vs. quiet-anxiety vs. stress-anxiety-depression. Where two posts answer the same question, merge them into one and 301 the other. Fewer, stronger pages are easier for Google to choose to index.

**Internal linking rule:** every post links to its pillar in the first few paragraphs. Every pillar links to all its supporting posts, and every category page lists its posts in plain HTML.

## Monitoring

The baseline is the last 28 days (Oct 11 – Nov 7, 2026). For the next 2–3 months, the indexed page count matters more than clicks, so track it first.

| Metric | Baseline | Where in Search Console | 3-month target (estimate) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Indexed pages | 8 of 142 | Indexing → Pages | 60+ |
| Discovered – not indexed | 107 | Indexing → Pages | Under 30 |
| Crawled – not indexed | 14 | Indexing → Pages | Falling |

| Metric | Baseline | Where in Search Console | 3-month target (estimate) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 404 pages | 6 | Indexing → Pages | 0 |
| Impressions (28 days) | 3 | Performance | 300+ |
| Clicks (28 days) | 0 | Performance | 10+ |
| Avg position (28 days) | 1.3 (brand only) | Performance | Not useful until more pages are indexed |
| Distinct queries (28 days) | 0 visible | Performance → Queries | 25+ |
| Pages with impressions (28 days) | 3 or fewer | Performance → Pages | 30+ |

**GA4 baseline (last 28 days, Oct 12 – Nov 8, 2026):**

| Metric | Baseline | 3-month target (estimate) |
|---|---|---|
| Sessions | 64 | 300+ |
| Engaged sessions | 11 | 150+ |
| Engagement rate | 17.2% | 55%+ once bots are filtered |
| Pinterest sessions | 0 | 150+ |
| Newsletter signups | Not tracked | Tracked as a key event; 20+ |
| Users scrolling to 90% | 10.9% (lifetime) | 20%+ |

**Monthly routine (first week of each month):**

- [ ] Note indexed vs. not indexed counts, and list any new 404s
- [ ] Compare the last 28 days to the previous 28 for clicks, impressions, CTR and position
- [ ] Export top queries and top pages to a dated CSV
- [ ] Request indexing for the next 10 priority posts
- [ ] Flag any page in positions 4–20 with 50+ impressions for title and content work

Check GA4 for engagement on the pages that do get search clicks. Search Console only covers what happens on Google's results page.

## Data notes and sources

- **Source of truth:** Google Search Console, read directly on Nov 9, 2026, for the URL-prefix properties `https://darlingwhatif.com/` and `https://www.darlingwhatif.com/`. There is no Domain property for darlingwhatif.com, so the two are reported separately and not deduplicated.
- **Data range:** performance data through Nov 7, 2026. The "16 months" view holds data only from May 20 (www) and Jun 24 (non-www). The previous-3-month average position is an impression-weighted calculation from daily rows; all other figures are as Search Console shows them.
- **Privacy filtering:** Google hides rare queries. Only 16 of 41 non-www impressions and 7 of 32 www impressions have a visible query.
- **Not included:** Search appearance (not captured), a lab PageSpeed test (couldn't be run from this environment), and Core Web Vitals field data (Search Console has too little traffic). No keyword volumes or third-party rankings were used.
- **Live-site checks** (status codes, canonical tags, robots.txt, sitemap, word counts and link counts in HTML) were made on Nov 9, 2026 by loading darlingwhatif.com directly.
- **Observed vs. inferred:** everything in the tables is observed. The causes (script-added links, `.html` redirects, URL changes) and all potential and target figures are inferences.

**GA4 (property for darlingwhatif.com):** read directly on Nov 9, 2026 for May 1 – Nov 8, 2026, using the Traffic acquisition (channel and source/medium, one pull per month), Pages and screens, Landing page, Events, Tech and Demographic reports. Monthly sessions add up to 700 against a 701 lifetime total; the difference is one session split across a date boundary. Only GA4's built-in bot filtering is on, and I couldn't confirm whether an internal-traffic filter is set. The live-site UX checks were made the same day in Chrome.

## Fix guide — step by step

This guide covers every issue in the report, in the order to fix them. The code fixes are already written and tested on a copy of your site. They're in `_private/fixes/` in your project folder, which is git-ignored and never deployed. Nothing on the live site has been changed.

**How your site is built (checked in the repo):** static HTML files in the GitHub repo `ifayeyu/darling-what-if`, deployed by Cloudflare Pages on every push to `main`. A GitHub Action then purges the Cloudflare cache. Post data lives in `posts.json`, which `posts.js`, `search.js`, `footer-recent.js` and the homepage script read in the browser. Newsletter signups go to Kit (ConvertKit) form 9478154.

## Issues found, and where each fix lives

| # | Issue | Fix | Part |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 107 pages never crawled; post links exist only after JavaScript runs | `prerender_post_lists.py` | A3 |
| 2 | 5,487 internal links point at `.html` URLs that redirect | `fix_internal_links.py`, `fix_js_links.py` | A2 |
| 3 | 6 old URLs return 404; 11 deleted dog posts still pinned on Pinterest | `_redirects` | A1 |
| 4 | Post hero fills the first screen, so the headline is hidden | `shorten_post_hero.py` | A4 |
| 5 | No newsletter signup in posts; the `/newsletter` page form is dead | `add_inline_newsletter.py` | A5 |
| 6 | No Pinterest Save button, no table of contents, social icons without alt text, `og:image` on the www host | `small_fixes.py`, `toc.js` | A6 |
| 7 | Homepage: Latest Reads 4 screens down, only 10 posts, "View all" goes nowhere | Manual edit | A7 |
| 8 | Nav missing Gut Health and Travel; empty Companion page | Manual edit | A8 |
| 9 | Pages not requested for indexing; sitemap and 404 report not revalidated | Search Console | B1–B3 |
| 10 | GA4 counts your own visits and bots; no signup key event; not linked to Search Console | GA4, Cloudflare | B4–B7 |

| # | Issue | Fix | Part |
|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | Pinterest traffic stopped in October | Pinterest routine | C1–C4 |
| 12 | Titles, thin category hubs, clusters, overlapping posts | Content | D1–D7 |
| 13 | Safari engagement far below Chrome | iPhone test | D8 |

### Before you start (5 minutes)

1. Open Terminal and go to the site folder: `cd ~/"Documents/Claude/Projects/Darling what if/Untitled"`
2. Make sure everything is committed: `git status` should say "nothing to commit".
3. Work on a branch so you can preview first: `git checkout -b seo-ux-fixes`
4. Cloudflare Pages normally builds a preview URL for each branch you push. You'll check the fixes there before they go live.

## Part A — Code fixes

Run every command from the site folder. Each script is safe to run twice, and each prints what it changed. To apply A1–A6 in one go, run `bash _private/fixes/run_all.sh`, then do A7–A9 by hand.

### A1. Redirect URLs that return 404 (about 10 minutes)

**Problem:** 6 URLs Google still knows return 404. They come from the old `/nourish/…`-style URLs and the deleted Companion posts. All 11 dog posts were deleted on Sep 11, 2026, but pins still send people to them; `/post-dog-sad` still had Pinterest landings.

1. Copy the redirect file to the site root: `cp _private/fixes/_redirects ./_redirects`
2. Open `_redirects` and check the targets:
   - `/nourish/tea-timing` → `/post-tea-timing`, `/nourish/acv-honey-morning-ritual-gut-health` → `/post-acv-honey`, `/beauty/screen-skin-blue-light` → `/post-screen-skin`

    - All 13 dog URLs → `/` (the homepage), because the Companion page has no posts left. If you'd rather send them to a specific post, change the second column.
3. Cloudflare Pages reads `_redirects` automatically; no setting needed.
4. **Check it worked (after deploy):** open `https://darlingwhatif.com/nourish/tea-timing`; the address bar should end on `/post-tea-timing`.

### A2. Point internal links at clean URLs (5 minutes)

**Problem:** 5,487 links in 138 HTML files point to `something.html`, which Cloudflare answers with a redirect. The scripts that build post cards do the same 10 times.

1. Preview the change: `python3 _private/fixes/fix_internal_links.py --dry-run` (expect "Would rewrite 5487 links")
2. Apply it: `python3 _private/fixes/fix_internal_links.py`
3. Fix the scripts: `python3 _private/fixes/fix_js_links.py` (expect posts.js 5, search.js 1, footer-recent.js 1, index.html 3)
4. **Check:** run the dry run again; it should say 0. Then open the preview site and click around the nav, a category page, search and the footer.
5. **Going forward:** when you write new posts or templates, link to `/post-name`, not `post-name.html`. Ask Claude to follow this rule in `CLAUDE.md`.

### A3. Put post links in the page HTML (5 minutes, then every publish)

**Problem:** category pages and the homepage start empty; `posts.js` fills them after load. Google often doesn't run that step on a new site, so 107 pages have never been crawled.

1. Run: `python3 _private/fixes/prerender_post_lists.py`
2. It writes a plain list of links into the `posts-output` box of each category page (beauty 19, mind 27, nourish 20, love 24, living 14, gut-health 3, travel 2) and the 30 newest posts into the homepage's Latest Reads box.
3. Readers see no change: `posts.js` replaces the box contents when it runs. With JavaScript off, readers (and Google) see the link list.
4. **Add it to your publishing checklist:** after `posts.json` changes, run this script, then `_private/generate-sitemap.py`.
5. **Check:** on the preview site, right-click → View Page Source on `/mind` and search for `static-post-list`. You should see 27 links.

### A4. Show the headline on the first screen (2 minutes)

1. Run: `python3 _private/fixes/shorten_post_hero.py` (updates the 87 posts that use the standard hero)
2. It changes `.post-hero` from `height: 78vh; min-height: 520px` to `height: 55vh; min-height: 340px; max-height: 600px`.
3. The other 7 posts use older hero styles (fixed 520px or 320px). Update the 4 at 520px to match by hand, or leave them.
4. **Check:** open a post on your phone. The title should be visible without scrolling.

### A5. Newsletter signup inside posts, and fix the /newsletter page (5 minutes)

**Problem:** the only working form is at the bottom of the homepage. The form on `/newsletter` has `onsubmit="return false"` and no destination, so every signup there was lost.

1. Run: `python3 _private/fixes/add_inline_newsletter.py`
2. Every post (106) gets a small "Letters from Darling" box before its 3rd section heading, using the same Kit form as the homepage. `/newsletter` is pointed at that Kit form too.
3. Each signup also sends a GA4 event called `newsletter_signup` (turn it into a key event in B5).
4. **Check:** on the preview site, sign up with a second email address of yours from a post and from `/newsletter`. Both should appear in Kit → Subscribers.

### A6. Pinterest Save button, table of contents, alt text, og:image (3 minutes)

1. Copy the table-of-contents script to the site root: `cp _private/fixes/toc.js ./toc.js`
2. Run: `python3 _private/fixes/small_fixes.py`. It does four things:
   - Adds Pinterest's own Save button on hover over post images (`pinit.js`, tall style).
   - Adds a collapsible "In this post" list to posts with 4 or more section headings.
   - Gives the footer social icons alt text (Instagram, Pinterest, RedNote, TikTok).
   - Changes the share-image URLs (`og:image`) from `www.darlingwhatif.com` to `darlingwhatif.com`, so they no longer redirect.

3. **Check:** hover over an image in a post on the preview site; a red Save button should appear. Long posts should show "In this post" under the intro.

## A7. Reorder the homepage (20 minutes, by hand in `index.html`)

1. Find `<section class="latest" id="latest">` (about line 1243) and cut the whole section through its closing `</section>`.
2. Paste it directly after the featured-story hero section, above "This Week's Story".
3. To show the 12 newest posts instead of one per category, find the comment `// 1 latest per category` in the Latest Reads script (about line 1475). Replace the code that builds `picks` with `var picks = all.slice(0, 12);`.
4. The "View all" link in that section has `href="#"` and goes nowhere. Point it at `/mind` (your largest category) or remove it.
5. Consider moving the newsletter section up to sit after "Explore by Category".
6. **Check:** on the preview homepage, Latest Reads should appear after one screen.

## A8. Navigation and the empty Companion page (10 minutes)

1. In the `<ul class="nav__links">` menu (and the mobile menu below it), add `<li><a href="/gut-health">Gut Health</a></li>` and `<li><a href="/travel">Travel</a></li>`. Or link them from the Nourish and Living pages if you want to keep the menu short. The nav is repeated in every page, so use find-and-replace across files, or ask Claude to do it.
2. **Companion:** the page exists but has no posts. Either bring dog content back, or add `/companion / 301` to `_redirects` and delete `companion.html`. Then remove it from the footer and regenerate the sitemap.

## A9. Review, preview and publish (15 minutes)

1. Review: `git status` and `git diff --stat`. Expect about 140 changed HTML files, 3 JS files and 2 new files ( `_redirects`, `toc.js` ).
2. Commit: `git add -A && git commit -m "SEO/UX fixes: redirects, clean links, static post lists, inline newsletter, hero, TOC, Pinterest"`
3. Push the branch: `git push -u origin seo-ux-fixes`, then open the preview URL from Cloudflare Pages → your project → Deployments.
4. Run the checks listed under A1–A8 on the preview.

5. Go live: `git checkout main && git merge seo-ux-fixes && git push`. Your GitHub Action purges the Cloudflare cache about 30 seconds later.

## Part B — Search Console, GA4 and Cloudflare settings

Do these right after Part A is live. They take about an hour in total.

### B1. Ask Google to index your strongest pages (10 minutes a day for a week)

1. Open Search Console → property `https://darlingwhatif.com/`.
2. Paste a URL into the search bar at the top ("Inspect any URL") and press Enter.
3. Click **Test live URL**, wait for it to finish, then click **Request indexing**.
4. Google allows only about 10 requests a day. Go in this order:
   - Day 1: `/post-hair-foods`, `/post-tea-timing`, `/post-acv-honey`, `/post-being-loved-feeling-loved`, `/mind`, `/beauty`, `/love`, `/nourish`, `/living`, `/`
   - Day 2: `/post-self-love`, `/post-attachment-style`, `/post-anxious-attachment`, `/post-emotional-safety`, `/post-gut-brain-connection`, `/post-cortisol`, `/post-morning-pages`, `/post-skincare-layering-order`, `/post-collagen`, `/post-hair-growth-retention`
   - Days 3–7: the six `-guide` pages, then your newest posts.
5. **Check:** in the live test, click **View tested page → HTML** on `/mind` and search for `static-post-list` to confirm Google sees the links.

### B2. Resubmit the sitemap (5 minutes)

1. Regenerate it: `python3 _private/generate-sitemap.py`. Make sure it contains no dog posts and no `companion` URL if you removed that page.
2. Commit and push.
3. In Search Console go to **Indexing → Sitemaps**, enter `sitemap.xml` and click **Submit**.

### B3. Validate the fixes in the Page indexing report (5 minutes)

1. Go to **Indexing → Pages → Not found (404)** and click **Validate fix**.
2. Do the same on **Discovered – currently not indexed** and **Crawled – currently not indexed**.
3. Validation takes up to about two weeks. Search Console emails you the result.

## B4. Stop counting your own visits in GA4 (10 minutes)

1. Find your IP address: search "what is my IP" in Google on your home Wi-Fi. Repeat on any other network you browse the site from.
2. In GA4, go to **Admin → Data collection and modification → Data streams**, click your web stream, then **Configure tag settings → Show more → Define internal traffic → Create**.
3. Rule name: `Me`. `traffic_type` value: `internal`. Match type: **IP address equals**. Paste your IP. Save.
4. Go back to **Admin → Data collection and modification → Data filters**. Open **Internal Traffic** and change its state from **Testing** to **Active**.
5. Note: if your home IP changes (common on home internet), update the rule. A simpler option for your own browsers is the Google Analytics Opt-out browser add-on.

## B5. Track newsletter signups as a key event (5 minutes, the day after A5 is live)

1. Sign up once from a post so the `newsletter_signup` event reaches GA4. It can take up to 24 hours to appear.
2. In GA4 go to **Admin → Data display → Events**, find `newsletter_signup` and turn on **Mark as key event**.
3. Optional: on the same screen, turn off the star on `click` so key events measure readers, not outbound clicks.

## B6. Link Search Console to GA4 (2 minutes)

1. In GA4 go to **Admin → Product links → Search Console links → Link**.
2. Choose `https://darlingwhatif.com/`, then your web stream, then **Submit**.
3. After a day or two, search queries show up in GA4 under **Reports → Search Console** (you may need to publish that collection in the Library).

## B7. Reduce bot traffic (10 minutes)

1. In the Cloudflare dashboard, open the darlingwhatif.com zone, go to **Security → Bots** and turn on **Bot Fight Mode**. Verified crawlers such as Googlebot are allowed through.
2. A day later, check that Google can still fetch a page: Search Console → URL Inspection → **Test live URL** should succeed. Also check that a new pin still shows its image.
3. In GA4 reports, add a comparison that excludes the cities Ashburn and Council Bluffs when you read Direct traffic. Treat Direct visits under 10 seconds as noise.

### B8. Keep the www property tidy (2 minutes)

1. Your www site already redirects to darlingwhatif.com, which is correct. Leave the www property in Search Console for history, but work in `https://darlingwhatif.com/`.
2. Optional: add a **Domain** property (`darlingwhatif.com`) via DNS verification in Cloudflare, so one report covers both hosts.

## Part C — Pinterest, newsletter and social

Pinterest is your fastest way back to real readers. It brought 175 sessions at 82% engagement before visits stopped in October.

### C1. Fix pins that point at dead pages (30 minutes, once)

1. In Pinterest, open **Analytics → Overview** (business account), set the range to the last 180 days and sort **Top Pins** by outbound clicks.
2. For any pin linking to a deleted dog post, an old `/nourish/…` URL or a `.html` address: open the pin → **… → Edit Pin** and change the **Destination link** to the current clean URL. A1's redirects catch the rest, but a direct link is better.

### C2. Make one tall pin image per post (ongoing, about 10 minutes a post)

1. Size: 1000 × 1500 px (2:3). Use your post hero image, plus a short headline overlay in your brand fonts (Playfair Display + DM Sans).
2. Write the overlay as the reader's question, for example "Why can I be loved and still feel alone?", not the post's "What if" line.
3. Pin title: the post's SEO title. Description: 1–2 sentences that use the words people search for (e.g. "melanin-rich foods for hair growth and shine").
4. Start with the posts that already earned Pinterest landings: cruelty-free beauty, softness, quiet-self, gut-axis. Then do the search-traction posts: being-loved-feeling-loved and hair-foods.

### C3. Pin every day (15 minutes a day, or one batch a week)

1. Aim for 3–5 pins a day, using Pinterest's built-in scheduler to batch a week at a time.
2. Mix them: 1 new post, 2–3 fresh pins (new image) for older posts, 1 repin to a relevant board.

3. Keep boards aligned with your categories (Beauty, Mind, Nourish, Love, Living), with keyword names and descriptions.
4. In Pinterest settings, check that darlingwhatif.com is under **Claimed accounts**, so your pins show your profile picture and you get website analytics.

### C4. Turn readers into subscribers (1 hour, once)

1. After A5 is live, write a short welcome email in Kit (**Automations → new sequence** on form 9478154): say hello, link your 3 best posts, and tell readers what to expect.
2. Send a short letter every 1–2 weeks with the newest post and one older one. This is how readers come back without relying on Pinterest or Google.
3. Track signups in GA4 (B5) and in Kit's form report.

### C5. Other channels (15 minutes a week)

1. **Threads:** share each new post with one line of your own. It sent 29 sessions at 69% engagement.
2. **sagemyhealth.com:** add 3–5 contextual links from related health posts to matching Darling What If posts. It sent 69 sessions at 2 minutes each.
3. **Instagram:** 6 sessions with 0 seconds of engagement. Make sure the bio link opens a real page (the homepage or `/links`), not a broken or slow link-tool page.
4. **Facebook:** 62 sessions, but readers left within seconds. Keep it low priority.

## Part D — Content fixes

These are edits to existing pages. After each one, push and then request indexing for that URL (B1).

### D1. Being Loved vs. Feeling Loved (20 minutes)

1. In `post-being-loved-feeling-loved.html`, change `<title>`, `og:title` and the `headline` in the BlogPosting JSON-LD to: **Feeling Loved vs. Being Loved: Why You Can Still Feel Alone**
2. Keep the meta description; it already covers "how to feel loved when you're alone".
3. Add two H2 sections, each with 150–250 words that answer the question directly in the first two sentences:
    - "What does it feel like to be loved?"

- "How to feel loved when you're alone"

4. Add each question to the FAQ block, in both the HTML and the FAQPage JSON-LD.

### D2. Hair foods and ACV & honey (20 minutes)

1. `post-hair-foods.html`: add an H2, "Which foods make your hair shiny?", with a short answer and links to the relevant foods already in the post.
2. `post-acv-honey.html`: if the post covers digestion, add a short, sourced section on honey and warm water for constipation, with a sentence suggesting readers see a doctor for persistent symptoms.

### D3. Turn the six category pages into hubs (1–2 hours each)

1. Under the H1 of each category page (`beauty.html`, `mind.html`, `nourish.html`, `love.html`, `living.html`, `gut-health.html`), add 300–600 words: who the category is for, the 3–5 sub-topics it covers, and why it matters.
2. Add a "Start here" list of the 5 best posts in that category, as plain HTML links.
3. Your Sept 15 audit has suggested sub-topics, e.g. nervous system regulation, attachment and emotional safety, hormone and cycle health.

### D4. Link the clusters (30 minutes per cluster)

1. **Love:** from self-love, attachment-style, anxious-attachment, emotional-safety, emotional-unavailability, quiet-love, slow-love, touch-language, easy-to-love and choosing-someone-every-day, add one in-text link to `/post-being-loved-feeling-loved`. Link back from it to 4–5 of them.
2. **Hair:** link hair-growth-retention, scalp-care, collagen, food-glow-guide and gut-glow to `/post-hair-foods`, and back.
3. **Gut:** link post-gut-health, gut-axis, gut-brain-connection, acv-honey, tea-timing and microbiome-skincare to the `/gut-health` hub, and back.
4. **New rule for your publishing checklist:** after publishing, add 2 links to the new post from older related posts.

### D5. Merge overlapping posts (1 hour per pair)

1. Read each pair side by side: gut-axis / gut-brain-connection; evening-sleep-routine / night-wind-down-routine; forever-young-at-heart / growing-up-keeps-you-young / looking-younger; anxiety / quiet-anxiety / stress-anxiety-depression.

2. If two posts answer the same question, move the best parts into the stronger one, then delete the weaker file and remove it from `posts.json`.
3. Add a line to `_redirects`, e.g. `/post-gut-axis /post-gut-brain-connection 301`, then run A3 and regenerate the sitemap.

### D6. Homepage title (2 minutes)

1. In `index.html`, change `<title>` to `Darling, What If — Wellness & Lifestyle Blog for Women` and update `og:title` to match.

### D7. Publishing pace

1. Until Search Console shows 60+ indexed pages, publish 1–2 posts a week instead of about 20 a month. Spend the saved time on D1–D5 and on pins (C2–C3).

### D8. Test on an iPhone in Safari (20 minutes)

Safari visits average 27 seconds and 28% engagement, against 3m 25s and 62% in Chrome. On an iPhone, open a post from a Pinterest pin, then check:

1. Does the page load fully, with no blank area where the ad slot sits?
2. Is the headline visible after A4, and is the text size comfortable?
3. Does the menu open and close, and does search work?
4. Does the newsletter box accept an email and confirm?
5. Do the fonts load, or do you see a flash of different fonts?

Write down anything that's off and fix it, or ask Claude with a screenshot.

## Part E — Check that it worked

Search results move slowly. Expect the first changes in Search Console 2–4 weeks after Part A is live, and clearer gains after 2–3 months. Compare against the baselines in Monitoring.

| When | Check | Where | Good sign |
|---|---|---|---|
| Same day | Redirects, clean links, inline signup, Save button, hero | Live site (A1–A6 checks) | All pass on desktop and iPhone |

| When | Check | Where | Good sign |
|---|---|---|---|
| Day 2 | `newsletter_signup` event arrives; mark it as a key event | GA4 → Reports → Realtime, then Admin → Events | Event visible |
| Week 1 | Google sees the static post links | Search Console → URL Inspection → View tested page | `static-post-list` in the HTML |
| Weeks 2–4 | 404 validation passes; "Discovered – not indexed" starts falling | Search Console → Indexing → Pages | Indexed count above 25 |
| Weeks 2–4 | Pinterest sessions return | GA4 → Traffic acquisition → Session source/medium | Pinterest 30+ sessions in 28 days |
| Month 2 | Engagement once your visits and bots are filtered | GA4 → Traffic acquisition | Engagement rate above 50% |
| Month 2–3 | Indexed pages, impressions, clicks | Search Console → Pages, Performance | 60+ indexed, 300+ impressions and 10+ clicks in 28 days |
| Monthly | Run the monthly routine in Monitoring | Both | Trend up on all rows |

**If something breaks after deploy:** go back to the last good version with `git revert HEAD && git push` (use `git revert -m 1 HEAD` if the merge created a merge commit). Cloudflare redeploys and purges the cache automatically.

**Files delivered in `_private/fixes/`:** `run_all.sh`, `_redirects`, `fix_internal_links.py`, `fix_js_links.py`, `prerender_post_lists.py`, `shorten_post_hero.py`, `add_inline_newsletter.py`, `small_fixes.py`, `toc.js`. Each was run twice on a full copy of the site on Nov 9, 2026. Each produced the changes listed above, and the second run changed nothing. The JavaScript was syntax-checked.